

Team development process

How we pick up, build, check and ship work on this project.

The steps

1	Consult Trello	Pick a card and assign it to yourself if it isn't already. If it is blocked or unclear, comment and flag it on the card, then pick another.
2	Sync the repo	Pull the latest main into your personal branch. Resolve any conflicts before writing new code.
3	Launch VM and Kubernetes	Use the setup scripts. If they fail, ask the team before continuing.
4	Write code	Work in small changes and commit as you go (see commit rules below). If you get stuck, flag the card and return to step 1.
5	Test locally (optional)	Run the tests when the change warrants it. If they fail, go back to step 4.
6	Push and open a pull request	Link the Trello card in the PR description.
7	CI runs	If CI fails, go back to step 4, fix, and push again.
8	Review (optional)	Self review or team review, at your discretion. If changes are requested, go back to step 4.
9	Merge to main	Move the Trello card to Done.
10	Tear down	Stop the VM and Kubernetes cluster at the end of your session.

Commit rules

- Use a proper, descriptive message (for example, "Add football-data.org client with retry handling", not "fix stuff").
- No false commits: every commit must contain a real change.
- Leave at least 10 minutes between commits.

Branching

- Everyone works on their own personal branch. Nobody commits directly to main.
- Sync your branch from main at the start of every work session to avoid drift and large merge conflicts.
- Open one PR per Trello card and keep PRs small. Merge promptly rather than letting work pile up on a branch.

Optional steps

Testing and review are discretionary and depend on the change. As a starting point: skip them for docs, comments and config tweaks, and do them for backend code, shared code (API client, database models, training pipeline) and anything that could break other people's work. If in doubt, ask a teammate to review.

Process flowchart

